



## Trump–Saudi Nuclear Deal: Contingency-Bound and in Limbo

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On 22 July, US President Donald Trump [announced an agreement with Saudi Arabia](#) that would allow the country to develop a civilian nuclear programme. Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, the de facto leader, [has cited concerns over Iran's potential nuclear capabilities](#) and stated that Saudi Arabia could pursue similar capabilities if Iran develops nuclear weapons. The multibillion-dollar agreement, expected to span more than 30 years, could create significant long-term opportunities for US nuclear technology, engineering and infrastructure companies. However, the deal's implementation remains uncertain following new political conditions from Washington.

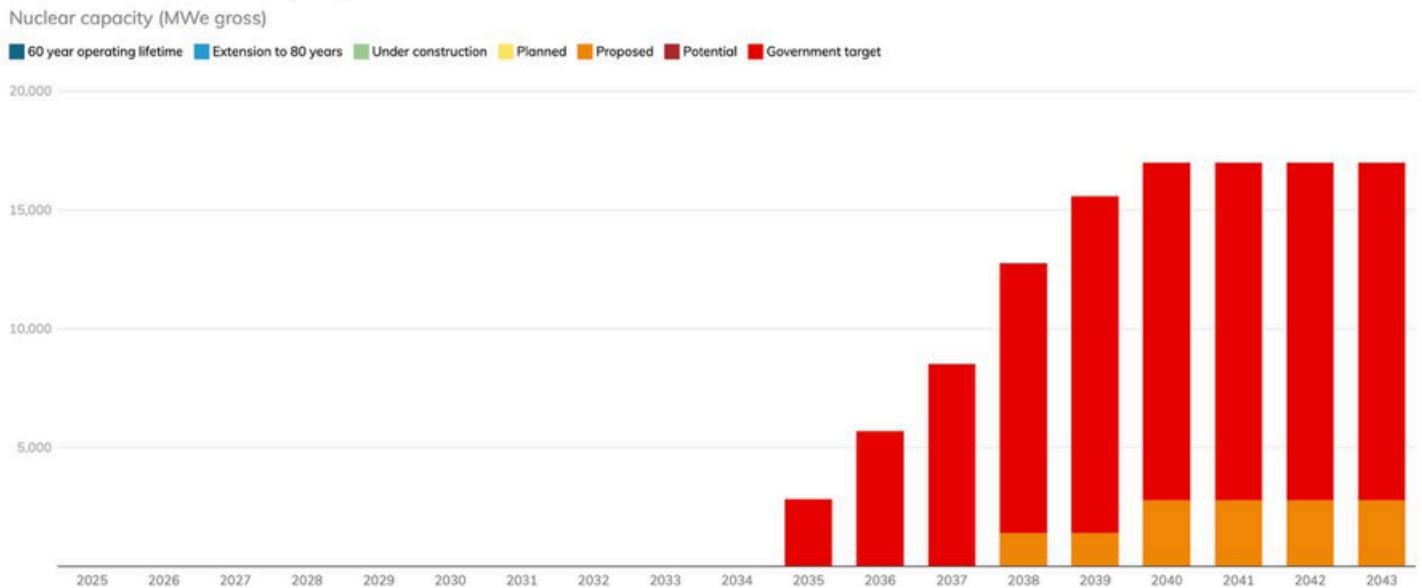
### Immediate Political and Market reaction

- Twenty-four hours after the announcement of the agreement, [President Trump stated](#) on social media that, for the deal to continue, Saudi Arabia would have to “first normalise relations with Israel.” This effectively throws into question the stability of the deal and whether it will move forward at all. The condition creates uncertainty for [US companies that could benefit](#) from long-term contracts linked to Saudi Arabia's civilian nuclear programme, as investment and procurement decisions may be delayed until the political conditions are resolved. [The agreement has also raised concerns over nuclear proliferation](#), particularly regarding the safeguards governing Saudi Arabia's programme and its potential ability to pursue domestic uranium enrichment.
- Israel has expressed concerns over the prospect of Saudi Arabia developing greater nuclear capabilities, while wider regional tensions have heightened scrutiny of the agreement. The final regulatory framework will therefore be critical in determining both the pace of implementation and the scale of the commercial opportunity for US companies.

### Commercial Implications

- The agreement presents a significant long-term opportunity for US nuclear technology, engineering and infrastructure companies, [but that opportunity remains contingent](#) on Saudi-Israeli normalisation, congressional review and the final regulatory framework governing the programme.
- In the short term, the agreement creates opportunities for feasibility studies, technical advice, regulatory support, workforce training and early-stage engineering. However, uncertainty surrounding Trump's normalisation condition is likely to delay major investment and procurement decisions, limiting immediate commercial gains.

## Projection of future nuclear capacity in Saudi Arabia



Source: [World Nuclear Association](#)

- In the medium term, implementation could generate contracts across reactor technology, construction, fuel supply, grid infrastructure, waste management, cybersecurity and nuclear safety. [US companies would gain access](#) to a major emerging nuclear-energy market while strengthening their position against competing suppliers from China, Russia, France and South Korea. Saudi Arabia would benefit from energy diversification, technical expertise and the development of a domestic nuclear workforce and supply chain.
- Over the long term, reactor construction, operation, maintenance and decommissioning could create a multi-decade pipeline of revenue for US companies. However, the scale of that opportunity will depend on the safeguards governing uranium enrichment and nuclear technology transfers. [Weaker safeguards could increase proliferation concerns](#) and encourage other regional states to pursue comparable capabilities, raising demand for defence, [intelligence and nuclear-security](#) services while increasing political and operational risks across the energy and infrastructure sectors. Conversely, strict oversight could reassure investors and regional partners, but it may narrow the range of technologies and activities available to Saudi Arabia.
- The commercial outcome therefore depends not simply on whether the agreement formally proceeds, but on whether Washington and Riyadh establish a framework that is politically viable, commercially attractive and sufficiently robust to contain the programme's wider security risks.